HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "What was done to me was my fault. I must have caused it."

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"What was done to me was my fault. I must have caused it." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I believe I should have done, and could I really have done it then?
- ☐ Whose choice was it, if I set my self-blame aside?
- ☐ Would I say this was a friend's fault if it had happened to them?
- ☐ Am I using blame to feel less helpless?
- ☐ What does "no condemnation" mean for a person who was hurt?
- ☐ What would my counselor want me to stop saying to myself?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ What was done to me was not my fault. I did not cause it, and I do not have to carry blame that belongs to someone else.
- ☐ I did not cause what was done to me.
- ☐ Wanting to have stopped it is not the same as causing it.
- ☐ I am not on trial for someone else's choice.
- ☐ God is near me. He is not accusing me.
- ☐ I can grieve without agreeing with the blame.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 8:1
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Psalm 103:13–14
  "As a father has compassion on his children, so the LORD has compassion on those who fear Him. For He knows our frame; He is mindful that we are dust."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] When you blamed yourself: Each day, write down one moment when you took the fault for what was done to you. Write what happened, what you told yourself, and one more accurate statement.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 8:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "What was done to me was not my fault. In Christ I am not condemned.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Guilt/Shame" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio or the Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone. If you are not safe right now, call 911 or 1-800-799-7233.

- [ ] Write the charge, then a fair sentence. One line of self-blame. Then one line you would say to a friend. No graphic detail.
- [ ] Ask your counselor to help you separate grief from blame. Stop if it becomes too much.
- [ ] Refuse one "I caused it." When the sentence starts, say, "That was not mine to cause," and stop.
- [ ] Read Romans 8:1 each morning before you review the past.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "What was done to me was my fault. I must have caused it.": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment I did not take the blame
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~What was done to me was my fault. I must have caused it~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have blamed myself for harm I did not choose. There is no condemnation in Christ. Teach me the difference between grief and guilt, and give me a safe counselor as I lay this down. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.